compress. However, the pain just wouldn't go away. I went to the Command Hospital at Chandimandir, followed by the Army Hospital R&R at Delhi but to no avail. Despite a battery of tests, they could find nothing wrong—at least nothing that could explain this spasm that had almost become permanent. With each Specialist adding more medicines to the prescription, I was taking more than a dozen pills a day. All through this, I continued with my visits to the formations and units and even to the field firing ranges, where I somehow managed to worm my way into the turret of a tank and fire an anti-tank missile. After about four months of this, I got fed up. The medicines were not making any difference, treating the symptoms and not the cause. I consulted my friend Milind Modak, who is an orthopaedist and has his own hospital in Pune, and took a two-week session of physiotherapy, which gave some relief, but nothing worked. So, I stopped taking the medicines altogether and actually started improving. I concentrated on building up my core strength and doing some yoga. By the end of the year, I could do everything, except bend forwards. I used to say in jest to my colleagues, 'I'll break but I won't bend'. I carried this condition right through and even as the Chief, I took all possible precautions that no programme or event should ever get cancelled because of my back. I gave up playing golf so as not to precipitate any spasms. I still get a twinge now and then and have a dull ache all the time, what the doctors call chronic pain, but I never gave up, and today, I am playing golf four times a week.

The GOC of 1 Armoured Division was Maj Gen Ajai Singh.[6] He was an extremely competent officer, meticulous and with an eye for detail. I remember that the first time I visited the Division, I inquired about something while we were at dinner. We had an early start the next morning and I went

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